

Hearth OS

Progress report · 29 September 2026

Summary. Hearth OS turns your living-room PC (Ryzen 7 5800X3D, RX 6750 XT, 24 GB) into a TV-style home screen for Steam, emulation, streaming apps and Quick Resume, driven by an Xbox controller or a Wii Remote. It is built on Bazzite and installs as a system image. In five days, 17 pull requests have been merged and every one has built and published an update. The latest batch adds search, game details, a temperature and throttling monitor, notices, sounds, and an ambient screen saver. That batch is published but hasn't run on your PC yet.

17

pull requests merged

49

commits

~11,200

lines in the home
screen and Quick
Menu

279

automated tests, all
passing

8

guides in docs/

Where things stand

Area	What it does	Status
Home screen	TV-style rows, racing liveries, backdrop from the focused game's art, controller batteries, clock	Confirmed
Emulation	ES-DE with a tile per console; emulators tuned for your GPU and TV; Dolphin	Confirmed (Dolphin working)
Wii Remote	DolphinBar pointer on the home screen and as a mouse; handed back to Dolphin for Wii games	Confirmed (pointer working)
Quick Resume	Hold Guide to pause a game and come back to it instantly (up to 3)	Shipped, check on PC
Quick Menu	Guide button overlay: audio, per-app volume, Discord, power, updates, quit game	Shipped, check on PC (reliability fixes in #12 and #13)
PC ports	ApplImages in ~/Games get a tile (e.g. Dusklight, the Twilight Princess port)	Shipped, check on PC
Streaming	YouTube (VacuumTube), Twitch (VacuumStream), Kodi, Jellyfin, Plex, Moonlight	Shipped, check on PC
Customising	Star any tile into Favorites with X; Y then Move to rearrange tiles	Shipped, check on PC
Search and details	Search every app and game; Y on a game shows play time and last played	Shipped, check on PC
System monitor	Quick Menu Stats tab: load, temperatures, clocks, power, memory, throttling warning	Shipped, check on PC
Notices, sounds, saver	Battery, install and update notices; optional UI sounds; ambient art screen saver	Shipped, check on PC
Profiles, folders	Per-person favorites; groups of tiles	Not started (deferred by you)
Netflix and similar	DRM limits these to low quality on any home-built PC	Not possible

Confirmed means you've reported it working on your PC. **Shipped** means it's built, tested and in the published update, but you haven't reported on it yet.

What was built, in order

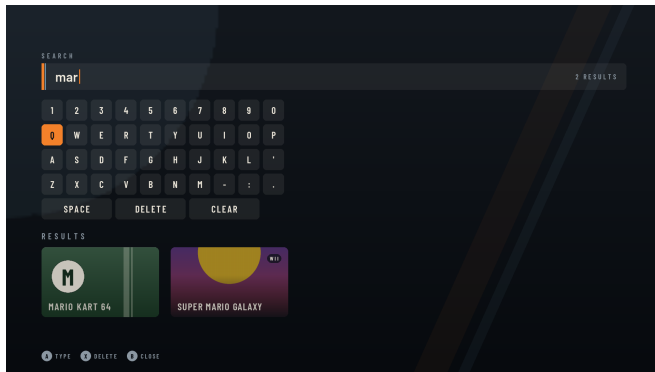
Date	Change
25 Sep	#1 · First image: AMD/Intel build on Bazzite (the NVIDIA image was dropped)
27 Sep	#2 · Racing look, diagnostics and problem reports, Wii Remotes, Settings app, game library, emulator tuning
27 Sep	#3 · Quick Resume: hold Guide to pause a game and pick it up later
27 Sep	#4 · Fixed first-boot app install
27 Sep	#5, #6, #9 · Steam's "Switch to Desktop" returns to Hearth; Guide leaves the desktop; RetroArch menu moved off Guide
27 Sep	#7 · ES-DE finds its emulators (ES-DE 3.4)
27 Sep	#8 · Wii Remote IR fix, Windows key opens the Quick Menu, edge-scroll the home screen
27 Sep	#10 · Wii pointer up/down, stick dead zone, quit a game back to ES-DE, Steam escape (hold Guide 4 s), PC games from ~/Games
27 Sep	#11 · Dusklight: the disc image in the game's folder is passed to the port
27 Sep	#12 · Guide keeps working when controllers reconnect; <i>hearthctl</i> buttons to test them
29 Sep	#13 · Quick Menu restarts itself if it crashes and never leaves the controller blocked
29 Sep	#14 · Fixes from your video: Discord staying open, Wii after Dolphin, Quick Menu mouse, button hints follow your controller
29 Sep	#15 · Twitch tile via VacuumStream, auto-updated and checksum-verified
29 Sep	#16 · Favorites row for any tile, move tiles, focus backdrop, controller batteries; comparison with TVs and consoles
29 Sep	#17 · Search, game details, Stats tab, notices, sounds, ambient screen saver, now-playing controls

Quality

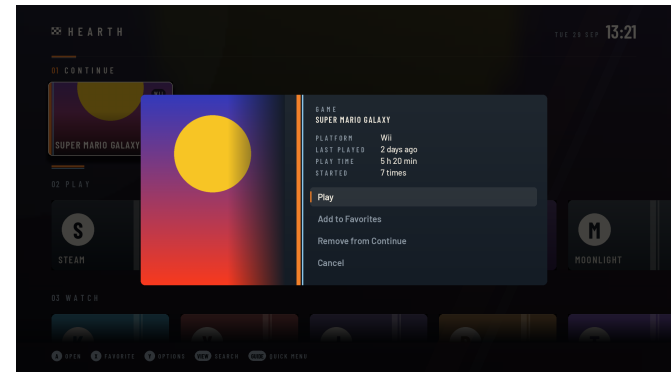
- Each change goes through: build, automated tests, screenshots checked, review, then merge. CI builds the full OS image on every pull request and again on main before an update is published.
- 279 automated tests cover the home screen, Quick Menu, input, Wii Remote, sessions, library, search, sensors and notices. They include end-to-end runs of the real home screen and Quick Menu in a virtual display.
- Problem reports (Quick Menu → System, or *hearthctl report*) bundle logs, hardware details, a screenshot and a timeline, with personal details masked. *hearthctl doctor* checks the setup.

Latest update: what it looks like

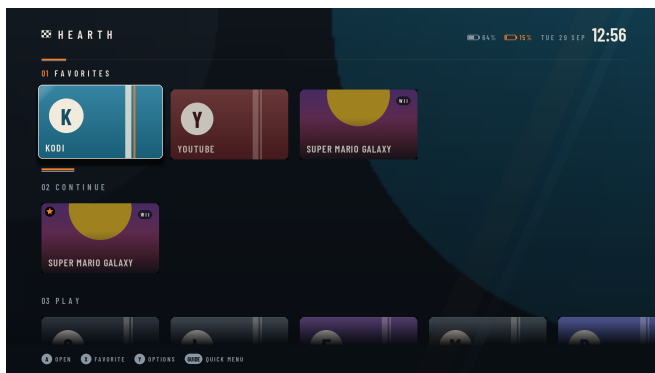
These are rendered from the current code with sample games. The Stats panel shows simulated sensor readings so the “slowing down” warning is visible.



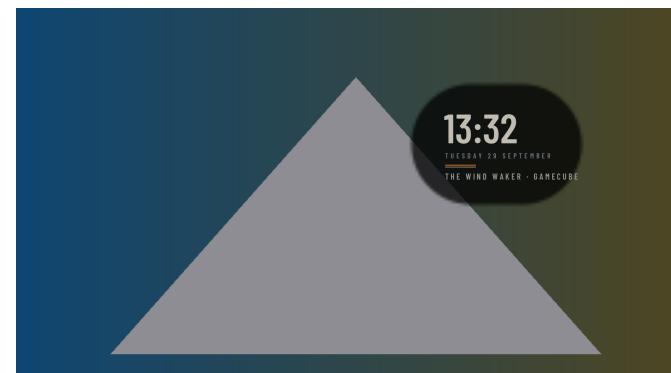
Search: press View (Share, -, or “/”) and type with the controller or a keyboard.



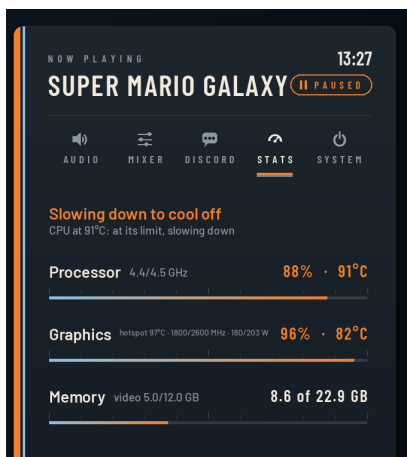
Game details: press Y on a game for platform, last played, play time and times started.



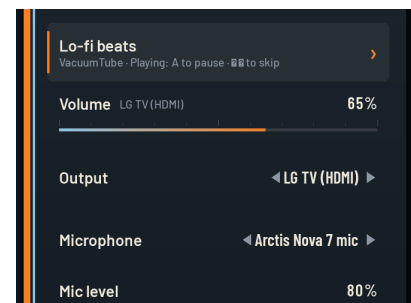
Favorites row: X stars any tile. Controller batteries sit by the clock and turn orange when low.



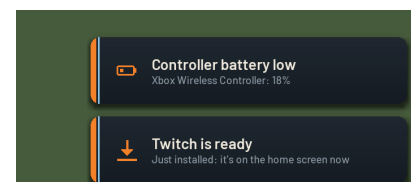
Ambient screen saver: your games' art, dimmed and drifting, with the time.



Quick Menu → Stats: load, temperatures, clocks and a plain warning when a chip is at its limit.



Now playing in the Audio tab: A plays or pauses, Left/Right skip.



Notices appear over a game without taking its controls.

Open issues

Issue	Where it stands	What's needed
Steam "Switch to Desktop" can still hang	Holding Guide for 4 s always gets you home. The root cause isn't known.	Output of <i>hearthctl status</i> and <i>hearthctl logs</i> right after it happens
Latest update not yet tried on your PC	Search, details, Stats, notices, sounds and saver are built and tested, but only in a virtual display	Update, try each one (checklist below)
Sensor names vary by board	The Stats tab reads the standard AMD sensors (k10temp, amdgpu)	A photo of Quick Menu → Stats during a game
README says nothing has run on real hardware	Out of date: Hearth runs on your PC	Update the project status section

After you update: things to try

- **Update:** Guide → System → Check for updates (or *hearthctl update*), then restart.
- **Search:** press View, type "mar", press Down to reach the results, then A.
- **Details:** press Y on a game in Continue. Check that play time and last played look right.
- **Stats:** in a demanding game, open Guide → Stats. Check the temperatures and clock speeds look sensible.
- **Now playing:** play something in YouTube, open Guide → Audio, and use A and Left/Right.
- **Sounds and saver:** Settings → Home screen → Sounds on; let the home screen sit idle for the screen saver.

Next up

- Fix what you find in the latest update on your PC.
- Steam "Switch to Desktop": find the root cause once logs are in.
- Wi-Fi strength next to the controller batteries (from the comparison with TVs and consoles).
- When you want them: profiles (per-person favorites and Continue) and folders/groups of tiles.